

Mindful Living Collective - Summary Snapshot

2026-05-09



Soldotna, Alaska | Data through February 2026

Mindful Living Collective (MLC) operates *The Goods* (retail), *Where It's At!* (restaurant and catering), and serves as community home for the Kenai Local Food Connection in Soldotna, Alaska. Established in December 2021 with a mission of empowering local farmers, food manufacturers, artists, and entrepreneurs, MLC is one of the central Kenai Peninsula's primary hubs for locally grown and locally made food goods.

Community Impact

Alaska imports the vast majority of its food. Since opening, MLC has worked to change that locally:

- \$1,934,366 in total retail sales through February 2026
- Local food products purchased from 187 local farmers and food manufacturers
- Goods sold or consigned from more than 60 local artists, makers, and entrepreneurs
- Provided hundreds of free meals to anyone who requests them through the Everybody Eats program
- Partnering with Kenai Local Food Connection and the Salamatof Tribe to provide our Stay Healthy Food Boxes to low-income tribal elders

- Serving as a community home for the Kenai Local Food Connection and an anchor for dozens of local food, music, and arts events

The Value of Keeping MLC Open

Alaska imports the vast majority of its food - among the highest rates of any state. MLC is one of the Kenai Peninsula's primary outlets for locally grown and locally made food, channeling \$208,126 in direct purchases to 187 local farmers and food producers since opening. Multiple studies by Civic Economics and the Institute for Local Self-Reliance find that purchases at local independent businesses recirculate roughly three to four times more money in the local economy than equivalent spending at national chains - on average, about 53 cents of every dollar at a local independent recirculates locally, compared to roughly 14 cents at a chain store. Every purchase at MLC circulates through local wages, local farms, and local families rather than leaving the peninsula.

Beyond purchasing, MLC provides food access that is not easily replaced. The Everybody Eats program offers free meals to anyone who asks. The Stay Healthy Food Box program, run in partnership with the Kenai Local Food Connection and the Salamatof Tribe, delivers subsidized, nutrient-dense food to low-income tribal elders. These programs exist because the business exists - if MLC closes, these services close with it.

MLC also serves as the operating home of the Kenai Local Food Connection and an anchor venue for local food, music, and arts events. The 187 producers who sell through MLC depend on it as a consistent, year-round buyer. Rebuilding this market infrastructure from scratch would require years and significant investment. Sustaining it requires far less.

Financial Snapshot

Profit & Loss history	November 2021 — February 2026 (52 months, cash basis)
Lifetime retail sales	\$1,934,366
Cumulative net income (all time)	-\$233,504

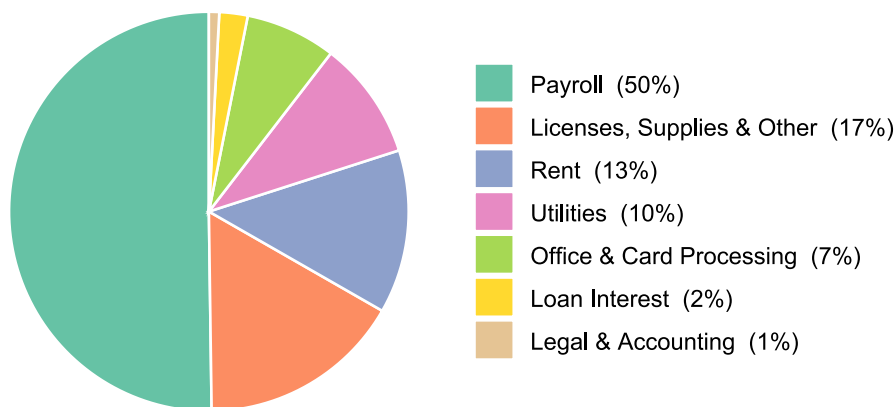
The business moved toward breakeven through 2023-2024, with mid-2025 being the most stable period. Revenue has declined in early 2026; the full report provides a detailed month-by-month breakdown and viability analysis.

Business Expenses by Category

Payroll is by far the largest operating expense, reflecting MLC's commitment to supporting local staff. Rent and utilities reflect the cost of maintaining a physical community space.

Total Business Expenses by Category

All operating expenses through February 2026

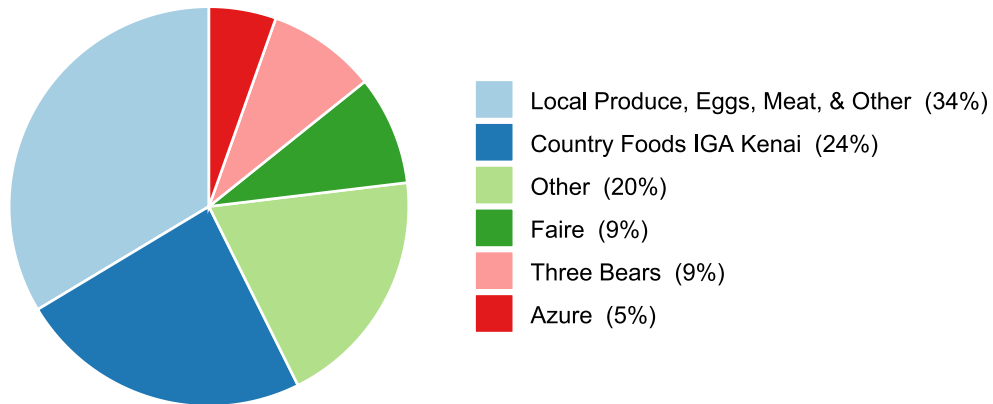


Cost of Goods by Category

Local produce, eggs, meat, and other locally grown products represent the single largest category of MLC's purchasing - a direct reflection of the business's commitment to supporting local producers.

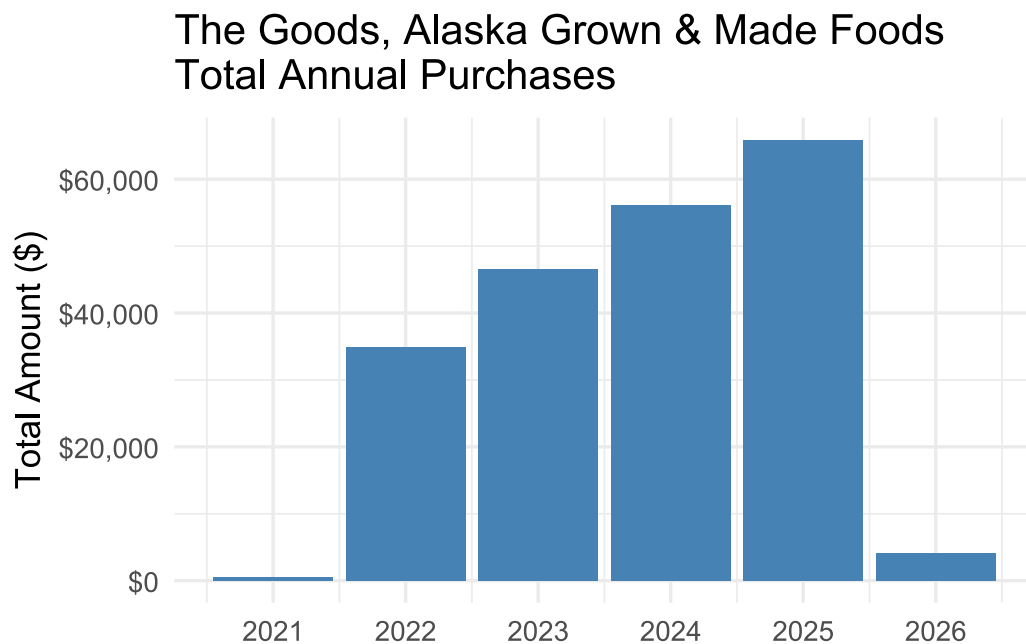
Total Cost of Goods by Category

All purchases made by MLC through February 2026



Local Food Purchases

MLC purchases local produce, eggs, meat, and other locally grown and manufactured food products directly from Alaskan farmers and producers - a total of \$208,126 since opening. The chart below shows annual spending by year.



Closing the Gap

MLC needs roughly \$31,242.65 per month to cover fixed costs. The business reached and exceeded this in mid-2025 - the goal is to return there.

Early 2026 has not come close. January 2026 saw just \$1,663.63 in revenue, an anomalously low month. February recovered to \$14,326.63 - still well below the floor. Averaged across both months, the gap is roughly \$23,247.52 per month.

Closing that gap could happen several ways:

- **More retail visits:** at the 2025 average transaction of \$34.30, the business needs roughly 678 more retail transactions per month - about 22.6 more per day.
- **Produce subscriptions:** at the minimum rate of \$55/week, each weekly subscriber contributes \$238.33/month. Roughly 98 subscribers would close nearly the entire gap on their own.
- **Catering and events:** additional bookings contribute at a higher margin and are among the fastest ways to move the revenue needle.
- **Direct financial support:** owner-investment and community investment opportunities are available for those who want to play a larger role.

Every customer who shows up, every booking made, and every subscription renewed directly shrinks this number. To learn more about investment opportunities or to get involved, contact Willow King at thegoodsalaska@gmail.com.

For the full report, visit the main page. Contact: Willow King ([thegoodsalaska\(at\)gmail.com](mailto:thegoodsalaska(at)gmail.com)) or Benjamin Meyer ([rivuletresearch\(at\)gmail.com](mailto:rivuletresearch(at)gmail.com)).

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